

FALL 2026 - GEO 261 DYNAMICS OF GLOBAL HEALTH AND DISEASE

TUESDAY AND THURSDAY LECTURE

11:00 - 11:50 am

Rm 110 Whitehall Classroom Building

Dr. J. Anthony Stallins

Professor, Dept of Geography

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Office hours

817 Patterson Office Tower

Mondays 12:00 – 2:00 pm

Tuesdays 12:00 – 2:00 pm

<https://calendly.com/tonystallins>

This course can fulfill the UK Core requirement for Global Dynamics.

We are not using a textbook. Three bluebooks are required and can be purchased in the bookstore.

A free online subscription to the New York Times is required:

<https://libraries.uky.edu/find-borrow/find-library-materials/find-materials-type/newspapers-microforms/digital-newspaper>

Links to NY Times readings will be posted online at:

<https://tstallins.github.io/courses/261/globalhealth.html>

This course has a face-to-face modality. All graded activities are done in person in-class without the use of digital technology. The syllabus is available in Canvas throughout the semester.

FRIDAY RECITATION

Section	Time	Location
1	9:00–9:50 am	208 Fine Arts
2	11:00–11:50 am	306 Barker
3	1:00–1:50 pm	306 Barker
4	9:00–9:50 am	306A Funkhouser
5	11:00–11:50 am	301 Barker
6	1:00–1:50 pm	301 Barker
7	9:00–9:50 am	311 Funkhouser
8	11:00–11:50 am	311 Funkhouser
9	1:00–1:50 pm	311 Funkhouser

Teaching Assistants

Ishrat Jahan

Sections 1, 2, and 3

Office hours, Tues 12-2 pm

822 Patterson Office Tower

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Kashish Gupta

Sections 4, 6 and 8

Office hours: Tuesday, 12–2 pm

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Fatema Tamima

Sections 5, 7 and 9

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COURSE OVERVIEW

Despite major improvements in global health over the past several decades, significant health disparities remain. Health and well-being vary sharply across countries, states, cities, and neighborhoods. These differences are connected to environmental change, urbanization, changing patterns in the spread of disease, and the development of new knowledge and technologies for identifying health problems. Global systems of trade, finance, and governance also influence where health risks and healthcare resources are concentrated. As a result, the forces affecting people's health increasingly connect local lives to global processes. Students preparing for health-related careers therefore need knowledge that extends beyond clinical practice. This course provides a conceptual foundation for understanding the global dimensions of health. We will examine how globalization can create new health problems, allow longstanding inequalities to persist, and offer new ways to understand and address health challenges. Because this is a Geography course, we will draw on ideas from anthropology, biology, ecology, history, political science, psychology, and sociology.

UNDERGRADUATE BULLETIN DESCRIPTION

This course is an introduction to health and disease from a geographical perspective. It provides an introduction to globalization; global health; epidemiology; the immune system; major pandemics of the 20th and 21st centuries; and global attempts to confront current and future pandemics. Connections are made to medicine, nursing, public health, and related fields. Fulfills the Global Dynamics requirement of Gen Ed.

COURSE AND UK CORE STUDENT LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of the course, the student will be able to:

Analyze global health issues and their connections to an interconnected world.

UK Core SLO 1: Navigate discussions and tensions around citizenship in a globalizing and interconnected society.

Evaluate how social, economic, political, cultural, and environmental factors shape global health outcomes.

UK Core SLO 2: Evaluate how structures and institutions intersect with global trends and local contexts.

Apply ethical approaches to addressing global health challenges and decisions.

UK Core SLO 3: Demonstrate ethical approaches to individual and collective decision-making.

COURSE ACTIVITIES

		Sum	Percent
Midterm exam	2 parts at 50 points each	100	22.5
Final exam	100 points	100	22.5
Friday recitation reading quizzes	13 at 10 points each	130	29
Friday attendance and participation	13 at 3 points each	40	9
Film essays	3 at 25 points each	75	17
Total points possible		445	100

Grading

A: 90–100%	Midterm grades will be posted on myUK. Final class grades are based on the percentage of points you earn out of a possible 445. For example, suppose you earn 88 of 100 points on the midterm exam, 92 of 100 on the final exam, 118 of 130 on Friday reading quizzes, 37 of 40 for Friday attendance and participation, and 66 of 75 on the film essays. Your total would be 401 points out of 445 possible points. To calculate your final grade, divide 401 by 445 and multiply by 100: $401 \div 445 = 90.1\%$. This would result in a final course grade of A.
B: 80–89.99%	
C: 70–79.99%	
D: 60–69.99%	
E: below 60%	

Skills and technology requirements. Students must be able to use [Canvas](#), UK email, a web browser, and standard document-upload tools. UK Core film essays uploaded through Canvas as Microsoft Word (.docx), OpenDocument Text (.odt) or PDF format unless other instructions are provided. Links to cloud documents will not be accepted. Canvas assistance is available through UK ITS at 859-218-HELP (4357).

Required materials. Students must purchase three bluebooks and should budget approximately \$4 total, although bookstore and online prices may vary. No textbook is required. Students must register for the free University of Kentucky New York Times subscription by following the New York Times registration instructions on the [UK Libraries Digital Newspaper Subscriptions page](#).

Required interactions. This course includes 42 required interactions: 25 Tuesday and Thursday lecture meetings, 14 Friday recitation meetings, the two scheduled midterm-examination meetings, and the final examination. Each scheduled meeting counts as one required interaction even when it includes multiple activities. Makeup work scheduled

during Prep Week replaces a missed interaction and does not increase the total number of required interactions

DESCRIPTION OF COURSE ACTIVITIES

Midterm and final exam. The dates are posted online on our [class schedule](#). The midterm exam has two parts to be taken on two consecutive class days. The final exam is during exam week. None of the tests are cumulative. Exams cover two sources of material: (1) content presented during class and (2) designated slides posted online that are not covered during lecture. Lecture content itself will not be posted online, only these additional slides that are not covered in lecture but are still considered test material. Exam format is in class, multiple choice, and will include identification and interpretation of slides from lecture. No notes can be used on the exams.

Friday recitations. No phones, tablets, or laptops are to be used in Friday classes. A quiz based on assigned readings will be given on thirteen of our recitation classes. You are required to attend the recitation section you registered for. Much of our recitation class time will be devoted to viewing three global health films over the semester. To fulfill your UK Core requirement in Global Dynamics, students will write essays in class by hand in bluebooks in response to a prompt about the film. Students who are absent on Fridays will be responsible for watching the films on their own outside of class. Notes will have to be entered from memory during the next class period after the absence. Attendance and participation points will be taken each class meeting. Attendance and participation points will be reduced when students are habitually tardy or exhibit repeated or prolonged distracted behavior in class, which will include use of phones, laptops, or tablets; wearing earbuds or headphones; sleeping; or doing work for other classes. Graded recitation work will be posted within one week of submission.

Friday reading quizzes. Assigned readings from the New York Times are to be completed before coming to recitation on Friday. All students are required to sign up for the free digital student subscription to the New York Times to access these readings (see the first page of the syllabus for the link). Our class schedule and the list of assigned readings are available at: <https://tstallins.github.io/courses/261/globalhealth.html>. Four articles will be read each week before coming to Friday recitation. Each Friday, a writing prompt will be assigned in class that covers the general content of the readings.

UK Core film essays. An essay will be written for each film. Writing will be done by hand in class without access to the internet or any electronic devices unless individually approved by DRC formal accommodations. Students are required to bring a bluebook to recitation at the start of each of our three films. Notes, observations, and reflections about the film are to be entered in class in these bluebooks as you watch the film. The bluebooks will be collected at the end of each recitation and then passed out again at the start of the next recitation meeting. At the completion of each film, you will be required to write an essay in your bluebook in class based on a prompt and any of your notes in your bluebook. The prompt will not be given in advance but will require you to interpret the film through the UK Core Student Learning Objective. You are not allowed to copy or insert printed material into your bluebook. Only students with an applicable DRC-approved accommodation may use a digital device for note-taking or essay writing, as authorized by that accommodation. Your essay grade will depend upon your understanding of and familiarity with the film as well as the student learning objectives for the UK Core in Global Dynamics posted in this syllabus. At the end of the semester, students will select their strongest essay for submission as an artifact for UK Core program assessment.

UK Core Mapping. The three documentary films are used to give students an opportunity to see the UK Core Global Dynamics learning objectives operating in concrete situations rather than simply encountering them as abstract concepts. Each film presents a particular global health story in which questions of health are embedded in relationships among people, places, institutions, and larger global processes. Through these stories, students can observe how tensions surrounding citizenship and belonging shape experiences of health and access to care (**SLO 1**); how institutions and structures interact with global trends and distinctive local social, economic, political, cultural, and environmental circumstances (**SLO 2**); and how responses to health problems involve ethical choices made at both individual and collective levels (**SLO 3**). The films are therefore chosen not to *teach* the learning

objectives directly, but to create situations in which students can recognize, interpret, and apply them.

Instructors will provide the historical, geographic, and global health context necessary for students to understand what they are seeing and to identify the larger processes represented in each film. For each documentary, students will then write an in-class essay that uses the film's people, events, conflicts, and circumstances as evidence for interpreting one of the UK Core learning objectives. Across the three films, the essays give students repeated opportunities to connect particular global health stories to the broader dynamics described by the UK Core. At the end of the semester, students will select the essay that best demonstrates their ability to make this connection for assessment of the UK Core Global Dynamics learning outcomes.

COURSE POLICIES

Tuesday and Thursday attendance. No attendance will be taken in Tuesday and Thursday lecture, but please remember that the lecture material will not be made available to you electronically. You are responsible for obtaining the class material if you are absent.

Friday attendance. Attendance is required on Friday recitation. In addition to losing attendance and participation points, failure to attend regularly on Fridays will lower your final letter grade by one full letter grade. Upon the third unexcused absence, your final letter grade will be decreased by one step, i.e., from an A to a B, or a C to a D, etc. Each additional unexcused absence lowers your grade another letter step.

All attendance information and excuses for Fridays must be sent to Dr. Stallins. Aim to notify your recitation instructor by email ahead of time for absences and cc Dr. Stallins on this email. Recitation instructors are instructed to send all emails from students to Dr. Stallins. You will have to consult with Dr. Stallins in person about whether a Friday absence is excused or not.

Prep days, reading days, and final examination schedule. Regular quizzes and final examinations will not be given on Prep Days, although makeup quizzes are permitted. No required interactions will occur on Reading Days, and any Reading Day makeup will be scheduled only with the affected student's agreement. No assignments or homework will be required during Finals Week, and the final examination will take place at the time assigned by the Registrar.

Makeup work. Makeup work for excused absences will normally be completed near the end of the semester on a Prep Day or, with the student's agreement, on a Reading Day. Makeup work will provide an opportunity to recover the missed points but may not reproduce the original reading-quiz questions or activity. It may instead consist of attending and participating in a scheduled Prep Day class and completing a short quiz at its conclusion; any Reading Day alternative will comply with University restrictions on required attendance and instruction.

Communication between teachers and students. Use the email addresses provided at the top of the syllabus to contact your instructors: ja.stallins@uky.edu. Identify yourself by full name in all emails. You will receive emails from the instructors throughout the semester. Make sure you have changed your settings in Canvas so that all Canvas email goes to your UK email account and does not sit unread in Canvas. Check your UK email daily. The instructor will respond to email inquiries within 48 hours so long as they are not easily answered by the syllabus, the online schedule, or by regular class attendance.

Excused absences and acceptable excuses. When possible, notify your recitation instructors and Dr. Stallins before a missed recitation. If advance notice is not possible, notify him within five business days after the absence. The following are acceptable reasons for excused absences: (a) significant illness, (b) death of a family member, (c) trips for members of student organizations sponsored by an educational unit, trips for University classes, and trips for participation in intercollegiate athletic events, (d) major religious holidays, (e) interviews for graduate/professional school or full-time employment post-graduation, and (f) other circumstances found to fit

“reasonable cause for nonattendance” by the instructor of record. Students may be asked to verify their absences for the absences to be considered excused.. Faculty have the right to request appropriate verification when students claim an excused absence.

Students anticipating an absence for a major religious holiday are responsible for notifying the instructor in writing of anticipated absences due to their observance of such holidays. Notice two weeks prior to the absence is reasonable and should not be given any later.

When excused absences prevent a student from meaningfully participating in the course or completing essential learning activities, the instructor will notify the student in writing. The student may elect to withdraw with a W. If the student declines the W, an I may be awarded only when the remaining requirements can reasonably be completed without compromising course standards or imposing an unreasonable burden. The remaining work, completion deadlines, and basis for determining the final grade must be documented in writing.

Generative AI. Generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT) may be used as study aids in this course. For example, you may use them to organize, clean up, or expand your own lecture notes; to generate study questions; to summarize or interpret assigned documentary films; and to help you better understand assigned readings. You remain responsible for evaluating the accuracy of any AI-generated information, which may be incomplete, misleading, or incorrect. Generative AI may not be used to complete, draft, revise, or generate answers for any graded course activity. All graded work will be completed in class, without access to a digital device. Submitting AI-generated material, whether copied directly or rewritten in your own words, as your own graded work is misuse and may be treated as academic misconduct under University policy.

STUDENT RESOURCES

Academic Policy Statements

<https://provost.uky.edu/instructor-resources/academic-policy-statements>

Academic Integrity and Academic Offenses

<https://provost.uky.edu/academic-affairs-operations/academic-student-policies/academic-integrity>

What Is Plagiarism?

<https://ombud.uky.edu/students/academic-misconduct-process/what-plagiarism>

What Is Cheating?

<https://ombud.uky.edu/students/academic-misconduct-process/what-cheating>

Mental Health Resources

<https://studentsuccess.uky.edu/get-help>

Your mental health is important to me. If you need campus resources, including referrals to the UK Counseling Center, please contact TRACS (Triage, Referral, Assistance, and Crisis Support) at 859-218-7227 or complete the Get Help form at the link above.

Student Well-Being

<https://studentsuccess.uky.edu/well-being>

Academic Support

<https://studentsuccess.uky.edu/academicresources>

Disability Resource Center

<https://studentsuccess.uky.edu/disability-resource-center/instructor-staff-resources>

Academic Ombud

<https://ombud.uky.edu/information-students>

Classroom Emergency Preparedness and Response

<https://provost.uky.edu/instructor-resources>

In an emergency, call 911 and follow UK Alerts, the instructor's directions, and applicable building and University procedures. If evacuation is required, use the nearest safe exit and do not use elevators. During severe weather or a shelter-in-place order, move to an appropriate interior shelter away from windows. During an active-aggressor emergency, follow the Run, Hide, Fight guidance. More information is available through [UK Alert](#).

COURSE SCHEDULE

Available at: <https://tstallins.github.io/courses/261/globalhealth.html>

UK Academic Calendar

<https://registrar.uky.edu/calendars>